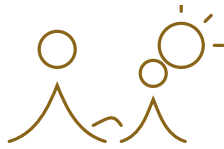


Dad's Code

The 30-Day
Present Dad Journal



*One small moment a day.
Thirty days to a closer kid.*

Present, not perfect.

by Jamie Wigg · Dad's Code

Two minutes. That's the whole deal.

One page a day. Each page gives you a **micro-action** to do today and **one line to write** tonight. Two minutes — that's it.

Don't aim for perfect. Aim for **present**. Miss a day? Just start the next one. No catch-up, no guilt.

— *Jamie, Dad's Code*

- 1 **Read the micro-action** in the amber box each morning. Keep it in your back pocket for the day.
- 2 **Do it** sometime today — it takes two minutes — then tick the box.
- 3 **Write one line** tonight: what happened when you tried it. That's what locks it in.
- 4 **Pause weekly.** A short check-in after days 7, 14, 21 and 28, then a final reflection on day 30.

YOUR DAILY PAGE

DAY 1 ● ● ● ● ● ● ● ●

TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

The thing to do today →

☐ I did it today.

Tonight, one line



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Give one child 5 minutes of your full, phone-free attention.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Say “I love you” first, before they do.



I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Turn fully toward the next “Dad, look at this!”



I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Apologise to your kid for something — out loud.



I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Ask one child, “What was the best part of your day?” and just listen.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Put your phone in another room for the whole evening routine.



I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Make up a silly song or handshake together.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

WEEK **1**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

Days 1–7

A quiet pause. No score to chase — just notice what this week gave you.

What's one moment from this week I want to remember?

What got easier?

One thing to carry into next week:

You showed up this week. That's the code.



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Catch yourself before one snap — breathe, then respond.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Tell one kid one specific thing you're proud of (not "good job").

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Let them choose the activity, and don't fix how they do it.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Sit on the floor and play *their* way for 10 minutes.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

DAY

12

SLOW DOWN



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Share one small story from when you were their age.



I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

PRESENT, NOT PERFECT.

DAY 12 / 30 · DAD'S CODE



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Do the bedtime routine slowly tonight — no rushing.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Ask, "Is there anything you wish I did differently?" Just listen.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

A quiet pause. No score to chase — just notice what this week gave you.

What's one moment from this week I want to remember?

What got easier?

One thing to carry into next week:

You showed up this week. That's the code.

TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Give a two-minute cuddle with zero agenda.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Eat one meal with no screens — for anyone, including you.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Say sorry to your partner in front of the kids (modelling repair).



I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Write your child a tiny note and leave it where they'll find it.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

When they melt down, ask yourself, “What are they really telling me?”

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Do one chore *together* instead of alone.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Tell them about a time you failed and what you learned.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

WEEK **3**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

Days 15–21

A quiet pause. No score to chase — just notice what this week gave you.

What's one moment from this week I want to remember?

What got easier?

One thing to carry into next week:

You showed up this week. That's the code.

TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Put work away 15 minutes earlier than usual today.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Name a feeling out loud: "I'm feeling stressed, so I'm taking a breath."

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Ask one open question at dinner and let the silence sit.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Create one new tiny ritual (your own “air cuddle”).

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Praise effort, not result, once today.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Let one small mess go without commenting.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Look them in the eyes and say one thing you love about them.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

A quiet pause. No score to chase — just notice what this week gave you.

What's one moment from this week I want to remember?

What got easier?

One thing to carry into next week:

You showed up this week. That's the code.



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Do the thing they always ask for that you usually say “later” to.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?



TODAY'S MICRO-ACTION

Reflect: what changed in 30 days? Write three lines — and keep going.

☐ I did it today.

TONIGHT, A FEW LINES

What happened when I tried it? How did it feel?

Thirty days. One small moment at a time. Take a breath and look back.

What changed in 30 days?

What did my kid get from this that I didn't expect?

One ritual I'm keeping for good:

You showed up for 30 days. Not perfectly — *present*. That's the code.

**You showed up for 30 days.
Not perfectly — *present*.
That's the code.**

Don't let the habit stop on day 30. Here's
where to keep it going.

KEEP GOING



The Dad's Code podcast

Honest, two-a-week episodes for rebuilt dads — in your pocket on the school run.

dadscodeshow.com/podcast



The field guide: “*Present, Not Perfect.*”

The full playbook behind these 30 days — the why, and what to do when it's hard.

dadscodeshow.com/field-guide